

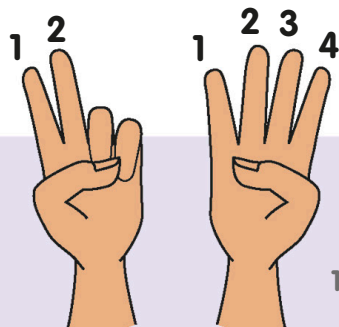
The finger calculator

Here's a brilliant way of multiplying together numbers between **6** and **9**, using only your fingers. All you need to know to do this are the **1** to **4** times tables. This technique will help you to check your answers for some of the trickiest multiplication problems.

Imagine you want to multiply together **8** and **6**.

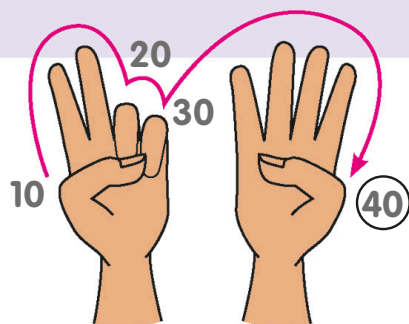
$$8 \times 6 = ?$$

Hold up a number of fingers on each hand equal to **10** minus the numbers you are multiplying.



$$10 - 8 = 2$$

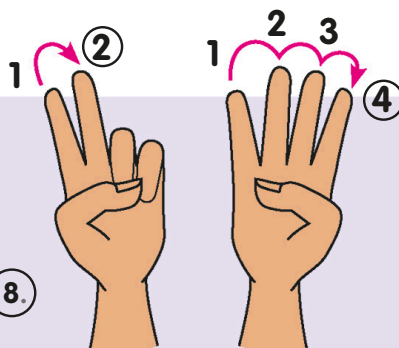
$$10 - 6 = 4$$



Count the bent fingers on both hands, and multiply by **10**.

$$4 \times 10 = \textcircled{40}$$

Count the straight fingers on each hand, and multiply them together.



$$2 \times 4 \text{ is } \textcircled{8}$$

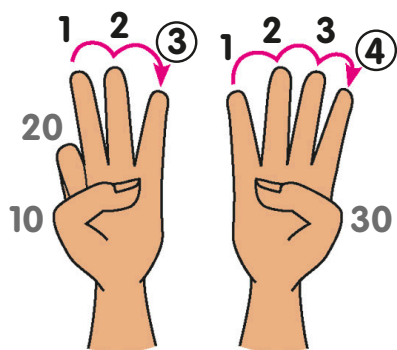
Add the two resulting numbers together.



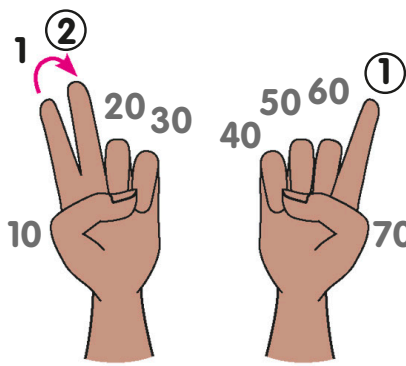
Bent fingers = **40**
and straight fingers = **8**
So the answer is **40 + 8 = 48**

Now try these for yourself.

What is **7 x 6**?



What is **8 x 9**?



What is **7 x 8**?

